

Lesson 06

English for I.T.



Role-Play

Two IT professionals, Alex (the Project Manager) and Jamie (the IT Specialist), are discussing an ongoing IT project involving the development of a new cloud-based software application.

Alex: Hi Jamie, could you give me a quick update on our **cloud-based software project**?

Jamie: Sure! We're on schedule to meet our first **milestone** next week. The user interface is almost complete.

Alex: Great! Are there any important **deliverables** for this phase?

Jamie: Yes, we need to finalize the **prototype** and conduct initial **encryption** tests to ensure our data security.

Alex: Good thinking about **cybersecurity**. Have we considered feedback from our stakeholders?

Jamie: Yes, they want to ensure that our cloud-based application supports **real-time collaboration** securely.

Alex: What about the project scope? Do we need any adjustments?

Jamie: The scope is still on track, but we need to monitor any additions carefully to avoid **scope creep**.

Alex: Agreed. Let's make sure everything aligns with our project goals and stays within the timeline.

Jamie: Absolutely! I'll also prepare a risk assessment regarding **third-party integrations**.

Alex: Perfect! Thanks for the update, Jamie.

Role-play analysis

1. What challenges were identified in the conversation regarding the project?
2. What steps did Jamie mention to ensure stakeholder needs were met?
3. What risks were identified throughout the conversation?
4. What strategies did they discuss to ensure the project stays on track?
5. Why was cybersecurity highlighted in their discussion?



Stressed Syllables

Practice pronouncing these words with the correct stress:

- | | |
|--------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. MILE stone | /ˈmaɪl.stoʊn/ |
| 2. DeL iverable | /dɪˈlɪv.ər.ə.bəl/ |
| 3. STAKE holder | /ˈsteɪk.hoʊldər/ |
| 4. S cope | /skoʊp/ |
| 5. TIME line | /ˈtaɪm.laɪn/ |
| 6. PRO totype | /ˈproʊ.toʊ.taɪp/ |
| 7. Cyberse curity | /ˌsaɪ.bər.sɪˈkjʊr.ɪ.ti/ |
| 8. En CRYption | /ɪnˈkɹɪp.ʃən/ |



Project Elements and Common Phrases

PROJECT ELEMENTS	DESCRIPTION	COMMON PHRASES
Project Title	Name of the Project	“Our project is named...” “I’m working on the project called...”
Goals and Objectives	What you aim to achieve with this project	“The primary goal of this project is to...” “We aim to achieve the following objectives...”
Key Milestones	Significant stages of the project and their completion dates	“Key milestones for this project include...” “The significant phases of the project are...”
Team and Stakeholders	Who is involved in the project	“The project team consists of...” “Key stakeholders involved in this project are...”
Deliverables	The products or results the will project produce	“Expected outcomes include...” “The project will produce...”
Challenges and Solutions	The challenges you faced, and how you overcame them.	“We faced several challenges, including...” “To overcome these challenges, we implemented...”
Current Status	Where you are now in the project timeline	“Currently, we have completed...” “The present status of the project is...”



Practice

Match each IT term in Column A with the correct definition in Column B.

Key term	Definition
1. Milestone	A. A preliminary version of a product used for testing purposes.
2. Deliverable	B. The boundaries and deliverables of a project, detailing what is included and excluded.
3. Stakeholder	C. Specific outcomes or tangible results produced as part of a project.
4. Scope	D. The overall schedule of a project, outlining key phases, tasks, and deadlines.
5. Timeline	E. A point in a project timeline that indicates the completion of a significant phase.
6. Prototype	F. Protecting systems and data from digital attacks or unauthorized access.
7. Cybersecurity	G. A person or group affected by or interested in a project and its outcomes.
8. Encryption	H. A method of converting data into a coded format to prevent unauthorized access.



Production

DESCRIBING YOUR IT PROJECT

Instructions:

- Work in pairs.
- Describe an IT project you have worked on or are currently working on.

Project Description Template:

- **Project Title**
 - **Goals and Objectives**
 - **Key Milestones**
 - **Team and Stakeholders**
 - **Deliverables**
 - **Challenges and Solutions**
 - **Current Status**
- Focus on clarity and organization in your descriptions.
 - Present your project descriptions to the class.

Discussion

1. Why is conducting a risk assessment crucial for IT projects?
2. How do you often communicate with your team?
3. How can we ensure the quality of our deliverables?
4. What criteria should we use to set milestones in our IT project?
5. What is one key lesson you've learned from past IT projects that we should keep in mind?



Key Vocabulary

TERMS	BRIEF DEFINITION	EXAMPLES
Cloud-based	Software or services hosted on remote servers and accessed via the internet.	<i>Google Drive, Dropbox, and Microsoft 365 are cloud-based applications.</i>
Cybersecurity	The practice of protecting systems, networks, and data from digital attacks.	<i>Firewalls, antivirus software, and data encryption measures enhance cybersecurity.</i>
Encryption	The process of converting data into a coded format to prevent unauthorized access.	<i>Sensitive information like credit card numbers is often encrypted during online transactions.</i>
Prototype	A preliminary version of a product used for testing and feedback.	<i>The team created a prototype of the app to demonstrate its features and gather user feedback.</i>
Deliverable	A specific outcome or tangible result produced as part of a project.	<i>A completed software application version is a deliverable in a development project.</i>
Scope Creep	The uncontrolled expansion of project requirements beyond the original plan.	<i>Adding new features to an application after the project timeline has been set can lead to scope creep.</i>
Integration	The process of combining different systems or software to work together seamlessly.	<i>We completed the integration of our new CRM system with our email marketing platform to streamline communications.</i>